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Wall

3.1.6.3 Wall

References:

Hebrew כֹּתֶל (kothel) SNG 2:9

Aramaic כְּתַל (kethal) EZR 5:8, DAN 5:5

Hebrew קִיר (qir) LEV 14:37, LEV 14:37, LEV 14:39, 1SA 18:11, 1SA 19:10, 1SA 19:10, 1SA 20:25, 1SA 25:22, 1SA 25:34, 2SA 5:11, 1KI 5:13, 1KI 6:6, 1KI 6:15, 1KI 6:15, 1KI 6:27, 1KI 6:27, 1KI 6:29, 1KI 14:10, 1KI 16:11, 1KI 21:21, 2KI 4:10, 2KI 9:8, 2KI 9:33, 2KI 20:2, 1CH 14:1

Description:

Fitted stones in a wall (MM, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons)A wall is the verticle surface that forms one side of a building or room. It supports the ceiling of a room or the roof of a building. We distinguish here between this kind of wall in a building and a city wall (see 3.13.3.1 City wall, rampart, battlement<REALIA:3.13.3.1>) or a boundary wall (see 3.6 Boundary wall, fence<REALIA:3.6>).

Translation:

The Hebrew word *qir* can refer to both the outer wall and the inner wall of a structure. Where a language has distinct words for these different walls, the translator will need to pay close attention to the context. For example, 1KI 5:13 mentions “the hyssop that grows out of the wall” (RSV). This “wall” is more likely an external wall rather than one inside a house.

In 1SA 25:22; 1SA 25:34; 1KI 14:10; 1KI 16:11; 1KI 21:21; and2KI 9:8 there is a Hebrew phrase that is literally "one who urinates against a wall." This phrase refers to men, so most translations say "man/men" or "male[s]."

In 2SA 5:11 and 1CH 14:1RSV says that King Hiram of Tyre sent Solomon "masons," which is literally "wall-stone workers/cutters" in Hebrew. These were men who shaped stones so they fit together neatly in a wall. GNT says "stone masons," and CEV has "stone workers."